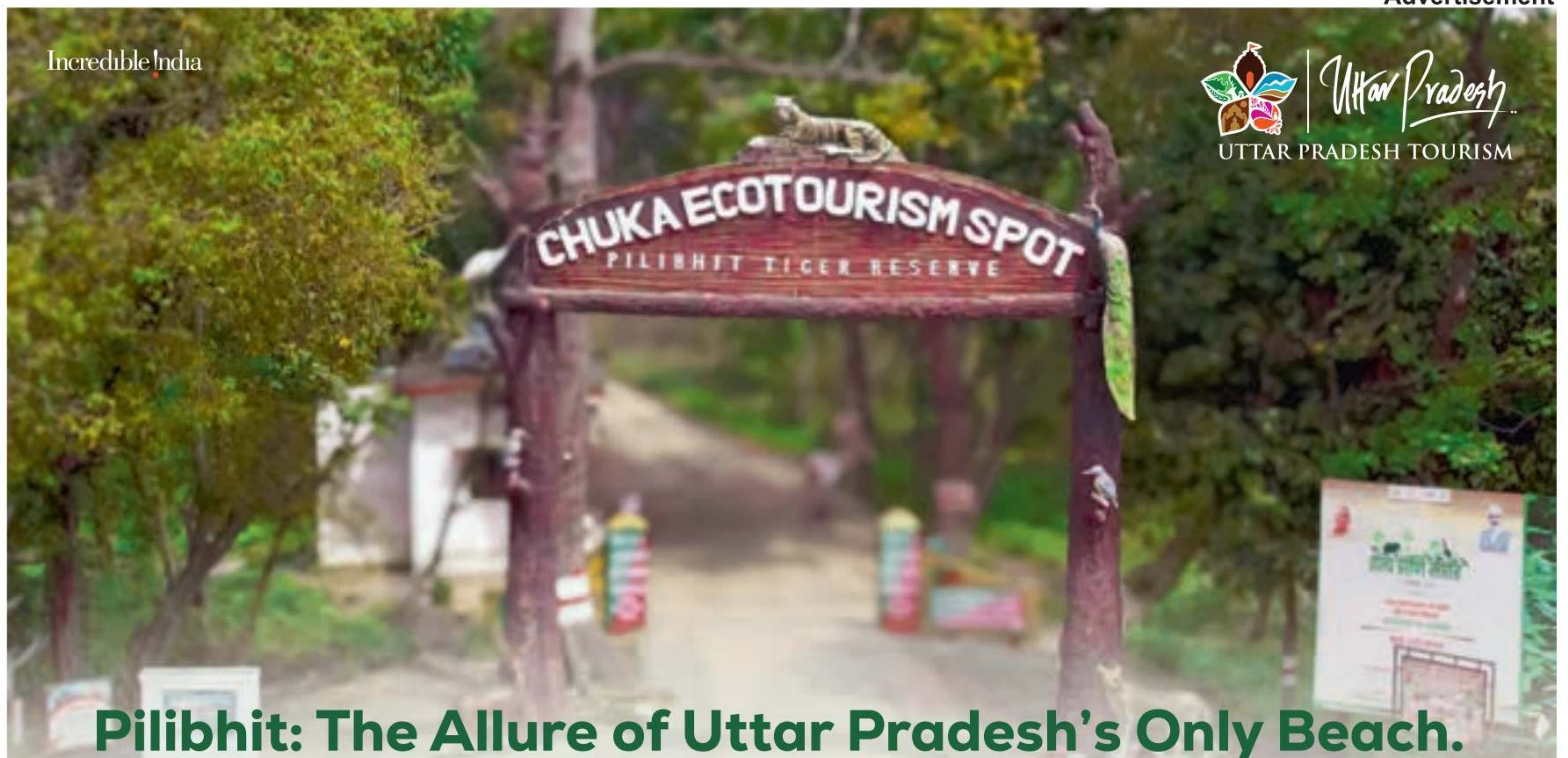


Incredible India



Pilibhit: The Allure of Uttar Pradesh's Only Beach.

Pilibhit, one of Uttar Pradesh's most popular historical, religious, and cultural destinations, lies on the border of Nepal and is surrounded by dense forests. Despite its proximity to the Himalayas, the terrain here is flat, offering a unique geographical charm. The region's historical significance is well-documented, with references in ancient texts like the Mahabharata. Pilibhit was part of the Panchal kingdom during the Mahabharata era and was ruled by King Moradhwaj, a devotee of Krishna and a close ally of Arjuna.

Pilibhit offers a peaceful retreat for those seeking solace amidst nature. Watching the sun set against a vibrant orange sky is a mesmerizing experience, making it a perfect getaway. The region's cool and pleasant climate, enhanced by its proximity to the Himalayas, attracts tourists throughout the year, offering clear blue skies and refreshing breezes. Pilibhit is also home to Chuka Beach, a picturesque beauty for the tourists.

For the nature enthusiasts, Pilibhit offers a blend of adventure and tranquility. Popular attractions include the Tiger Reserve, Chuka Beach, Sapt Sarovar, and Sharda Sagar Dam. The thrill of mounting in an open vehicle and moving through the terrains of the jungle and observing every call of spotting a tiger can skip one's heart beat when the eyes meet with a majestic royal Bengal tiger. Pilibhit is ideal for eco-tourists, offering affordable ways to explore dense forests and enjoy the beach-like vibes of Chuka.

Chuka Beach, located between the Sharda Canal and Sharda Sagar Dam, is a hidden gem in Uttar Pradesh. While it lacks the sandy shores of Goa, its lush greenery and unique accommodations, such as tree houses, offer a one-of-a-kind experience. Visitors can enjoy sunbathing in the winter, making it an attractive destination for relaxation. Pilibhit is also home to the renowned Tiger

Reserve, established in 2008 under the "Project Tiger" initiative, covering an area of 1,087 square kilometers. The reserve is a haven for wildlife enthusiasts and budget-friendly travelers. Surrounded by a significant tiger population, the stay at the tree houses here offers an aerial view of the dense forest where the big cats are always of the prowl.

Other notable attractions include Sapt Sarovar, which was developed during the British era and now draws large crowds with its serene ponds and scenic beauty. The Sharda Sagar Dam, a 25-kilometer-long marvel, offers breathtaking sunset views, while the Bifurcation Point, a canal junction surrounded by forests, is another captivating spot. Pilibhit also offers unique staying options with an ancient tribe called Tharus. Staying at the tharu huts offers a one of its kind experience with a better understanding of the traditions of the tribes in the region. The stay can be arranged through advance booking.

The state government is making efforts to integrate the tribal population with the eco-tourism initiatives, promoting tourism, opportunities for increasing livelihood of the tribes and also promoting sustainability. Religious landmarks like the Gaurishankar Temple and the Radharaman Temple further enhance Pilibhit's appeal. These temples, known for their intricate craftsmanship, are significant pilgrimage sites.

Accessible by air, rail, and road, Pilibhit is well-connected to major cities, with Lucknow being the nearest airport. The best time to visit Pilibhit is between October and April when the weather is pleasant and the beauty of the forest is at its peak. Whether one is a nature lover, adventure seeker, or cultural enthusiast, Pilibhit offers something for everyone, making it an unforgettable destination in Uttar Pradesh.